Coleson Weir

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Fields of Interest

Development Economics, Political Economy, Economics of Gender

Education

Ph.D. Economics, University of Notre Dame	May 2027 (exp.)
M.A. Economics, University of Notre Dame	July 2023
M.S. Economics and Applied Econometrics, University of Delaware	May 2022
H.B.S. Mathematics and Economics, University of Delaware *magna cum laude,* Minors – Political Science and Theatre Studies	May 2022

Job Market Paper

"Boundaries, Representation, and Local Growth: How Electoral Redistricting Shapes Political Candidacy and Economic Development"

Abstract: This paper examines how electoral redistricting affects political candidacy, representation, and economic development. I utilize India's 2008 Delimitation, which was the world's largest redistricting exercise, as a natural experiment. Redistricting generates constituency-level variation in voter composition and changes in which seats are reserved for candidates from historically disadvantaged social groups. I find that parties nominate more incumbents and fewer previous runners-up in constituencies with more new voters; these constituencies see no altered provision of public goods. Changes in the reservation status of a constituency reduce both incumbent nominations and the probability that an incumbent wins reelection; these constituencies see increased public goods provision and higher nighttime lights growth in the years following redistricting. The findings suggest redistricting boosts local economic development only when it constrains parties' ability to protect incumbents.

Publications

Weir, Coleson. "Education, marriage, and banning female genital cutting: evidence from Benin" *Journal of Population Economics* 39, no. 2 (2026): 28. https://doi.org/10.1007/s00148-026-01172-0

Iyer, Lakshmi, and Coleson Weir. "The colonial legacy in India: How persistent are the effects of historical institutions?." *Journal of Development Economics* 177 (2025): 103576. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jdeveco.2025.103576

Working Papers

"Redrawing the Lines: Did Political Incumbents Influence Electoral Redistricting in India?" (link)
with Lakshmi Iyer and Susan Ostermann.

"Gender Quotas, Public Goods Provision, and Public Opinion: Does the Type of Quota Matter?"
(link)

Selected Works-in-Progress

"Gerrymandering Gender: Electoral Redistricting and Women's Political Representation in the United States"

"Dividing Lines: Redistricting, Race, and Party Vote Shares"

"Female Prosecutors and Gender Based Violence"
with Haley Wilbert

"Free Primary Education and Intimate Partner Violence"
with Taryn Dinkelman

Pre-PhD Research

Ardila-Mantilla, Federico, Naya Banerjee, and Coleson Weir. "Markov chains, CAT (0) cube complexes, and enumeration: monotone paths in a strip mix slowly." *International Mathematics Research Notices* 2026, no. 4 (2026): rnag004. https://doi.org/10.1093/imrn/rnag004

Policy Publication

"Retirement Investments: Agencies Can Better Oversee Conflicts of Interest Between Fiduciaries and Investors" (US GAO Report 24-104632)

Research Affiliations

Member, Representation of Women Lab	2026 – present
Graduate Student Affiliate, Building Inclusive Growth Lab	2023 – present
Ph.D. Fellow, Kellogg Institute for International Studies	2022 – present

Research Experience

Research Assistant to Lakshmi Iyer, University of Notre Dame	2023 – 2024
Research Assistant to Naya Banerjee, University of Delaware	2018 – 2020

Teaching Experience

University of Notre Dame

Instructor, Introduction to Linear Regression	Spring 2025, Fall 2025

Instructor, Economics PhD Math Camp	Summers 2024 – 2025
Instructor, Principles of Microeconomics	Summer 2025
Instructor, Development Data Bootcamp	Spring 2025
University of Delaware	
Tutor, Econometric Methods and Models I	Fall 2021, Spring 2021
Tutor, Introduction to Econometrics	Spring 2020 – Spring 2021, Spring 2022
Tutor, Quantitative Macroeconomic Theory	Fall 2021, Spring 2022
Tutor, Introduction to Microeconomics	Fall 2019, Spring 2020

Presentations

2026 Gender and Representation Workshop (Representation of Women Lab)
2025 Midwest International Economic Development Conference (Univ of Illinois Urbana-Champaign), Notre Dame Interdisciplinary Research Symposium
2024 NEUDC (Northeastern Univ), Workshop on Historical Institutions and Their Legacies (Norwegian Univ of Science and Technology)
2023 International Atlantic Economic Conference

Honors, Awards, and Grants

University of Notre Dame	
2nd place – Best Oral Presentation, Interdisciplinary Research Symposium	2025
Kellogg Institute Conference Travel Grant	2024
Kellogg Institute Conference Travel Grant	2023
University of Delaware	
Sally Latham Graduate Research Award, Department of Economics	2022
The Economics Graduate Scholar Award, Department of Economics	2022
Bertram F. Levin Memorial Award, Department of Economics	2022
Hutchinson Scholar, Department of Economics	2021 – 2022
Carl J. Rees Scholar, Department of Mathematical Sciences	2020 – 2021
Charles N. Lanier Scholar, Department of Economics	2020 – 2022
General Honors Award, Honors College	2020
Telkes Distinguished Scholar, Honors College	2018 – 2022

Service

Referee: *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, BMJ Global Health, BMJ Public Health, Economic Modelling, Journal of Development Economics (x2), Journal of Human Resources*

University of Notre Dame	
Graduate Student Conference Resource, Kellogg Institute	2025 – present
Graduate Representative, Committee on Sexual Assault Prevention	2024 – 2026
Treasurer, Graduate Student Government	2024 – 2026
Member, Conference Presentation Grant Review Committee	2024 – 2026
Economics Department Representative, Graduate Student Government	2024 – 2025

Computational Skills

Stata, ArcGIS, R, Mathematica, MATLAB, LaTeX

Other Work Experience

Program and Management Analyst Intern, U.S. Government Accountability Office Education, Workforce, and Income Security	2021
Research Intern, Wasmer, Schroeder & Company Credit Research Department	2020
Resident Assistant and Office Manager, University of Delaware Residence Life and Housing	2019 – 2022

References

Lakshmi Iyer (Chair)
Professor of Economics and Global Affairs
University of Notre Dame
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Taryn Dinkelman
Associate Professor of Economics
University of Notre Dame
Email: tdinkelm@nd.edu

Enrique Seira Bejarano
Joe and Deborah Loughrey Professor of Economics
University of Notre Dame
Email: eseirabe@nd.edu

Susan Ostermann
Associate Professor of Global Affairs
Concurrent Associate Professor of Political Science
University of Notre Dame
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